

MBA ROCK

THE EXECUTIVE OPERATING SYSTEM

10 Modules. 50 Lessons. The Plan is the Artifact.

THE ARCHITECTURE

M1: Finance

The Oxygen

M2: Strategy

The Moat

M3: People

The Culture

M4: Unit Economics

The Physics

M5: Tech & Digital

The Backbone

M6: Growth & Capital

The Engine

M7: Marketing

The Demand

M8: Operations

The Execution

M9: Analytics

The Evidence

M10: Innovation

The Future

M1

FINANCE THE OXYGEN & THE TRUTH

1. Oxygen (Runway)

2. Breakeven Proof

3. Top Line Lie

4. Receivables In

5. Bones in Spreadsheets

Profit is an OPINION.
Cash is OXYGEN.

Run out of oxygen, the business dies—no matter how pretty the P&L looks.

THE DEFINITION OF CASH FLOW

~~NOT Revenue~~

~~NOT Net Profit~~

~~NOT Accounts
Receivable~~



**Actual money
moving in and
out of the bank
account.
Dollars you can
spend today.**

THE RUNWAY LEVERS

1. Cut Burn

(Extend runway immediately. Cheapest lever.)

2. Accelerate Collections

(Pull forward cash owed. Moderate effort.)

3. Raise Capital

(Sell equity or take debt. Most expensive lever.)

Pull the cheapest lever first. Capital is the last resort.

THE SURVIVAL EQUATION

$$\text{[Cash on Hand]} \div \text{[Monthly Burn]} = \text{[Months of Oxygen]}$$

Bank: \$240,000

Burn: \$40,000/mo

Result: 6 Months Runway

< 3 Months = Suffocating. < 1 Month = Dead.

WORKSHEET: THE HEALTH CHECK

Company A

Cash: \$500K

Burn: \$80K

Company B

Cash: \$1.2M

Burn: \$300K

Company C

Cash: \$90K

Burn: \$45K

Which is healthiest?

Which is healthiest?

Which needs immediate action?

THE ACTION

**Calculate your runway today.
If under 6 months, build a
90-day cash plan. Oxygen first.**

NEXT UP: LESSON 1.2 — THE BREAK-EVEN PROOF

MO

ANALYTICS THE EVIDENCE

1. Data-Driven Decisions

2. KPIs & Dashboards

3. A/B Testing

4. Forecasting

5. Risk Management

Match the rigor of
EVIDENCE analysis
to the reversibility
of the decision.

Reversible decisions deserve speed. Irreversible decisions deserve EVIDENCE.

THE DECISION QUALITY SIX

1. Frame
[Right question,
right scope]

2. Alternatives
[At least three,
including 'do nothing']

3. Information
[Relevant data,
honest uncertainty]

4. Values
[Explicit tradeoffs]

5. Logic
[Sound reasoning]

6. Commitment
[Follow-through]

QUALITY

THE REVERSIBILITY TEST (BEZOS)

Type 1 (One-Way Doors)

- Irreversible, High Stakes
- Requires: Deliberation, evidence-heavy

Type 2 (Two-Way Doors)

- Reversible, Low Stakes
- Requires: Speed, judgment-led

Warning: Most orgs apply Type 1 process to Type 2 decisions and pay a massive tax in speed.

THE DATA HIERARCHY



COGNITIVE TRAPS

- Confirmation Bias
- Anchoring
- Sunk Cost
- Narrative Fallacy

WORKSHEET: THE DECISION AUDIT



Classify your last 5 major decisions as Type 1 or Type 2.



**Identify where you over-deliberated
(Type 2 treated as Type 1).**



**Identify where you under-deliberated
(Type 1 treated as Type 2).**



Build a decision log to track quality vs outcome.

THE ACTION

**Institute the Reversibility Test today.
Stop bottlenecking two-way doors.**

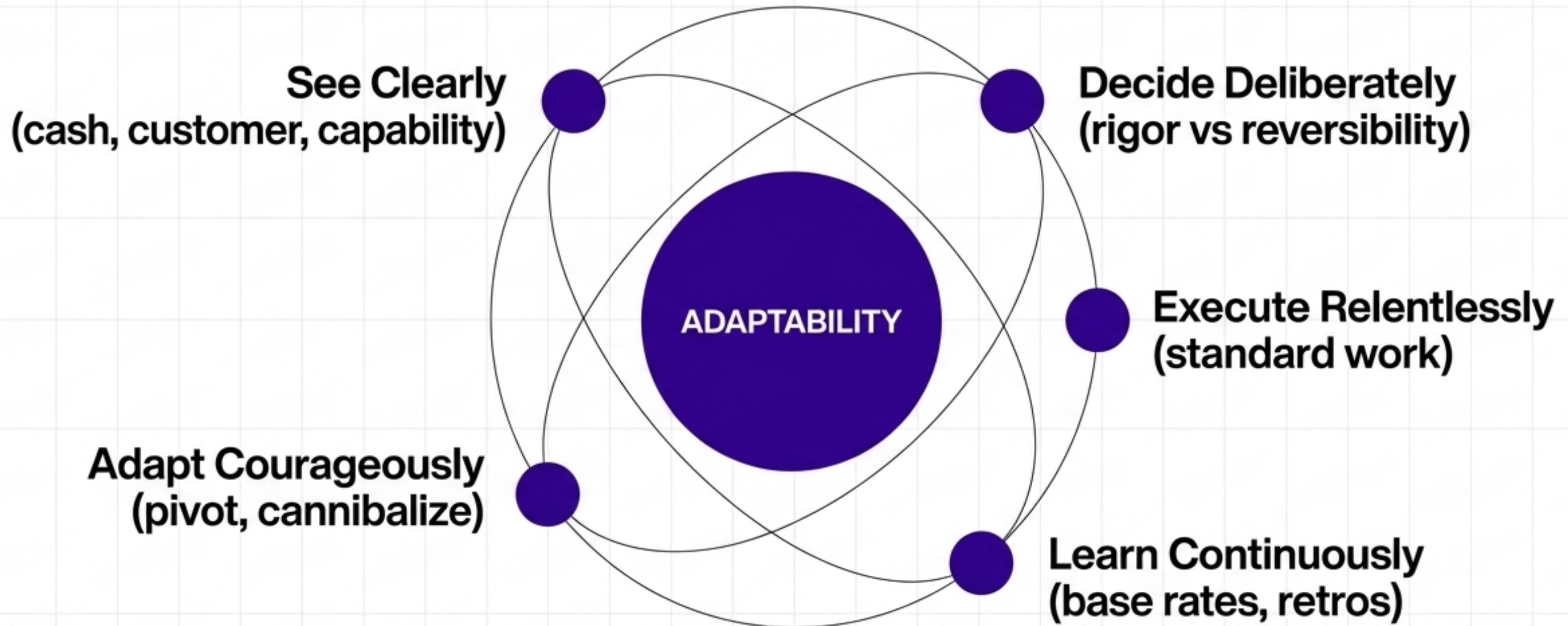
NEXT UP: LESSON 9.2 — KPIs & DASHBOARDS

MM10

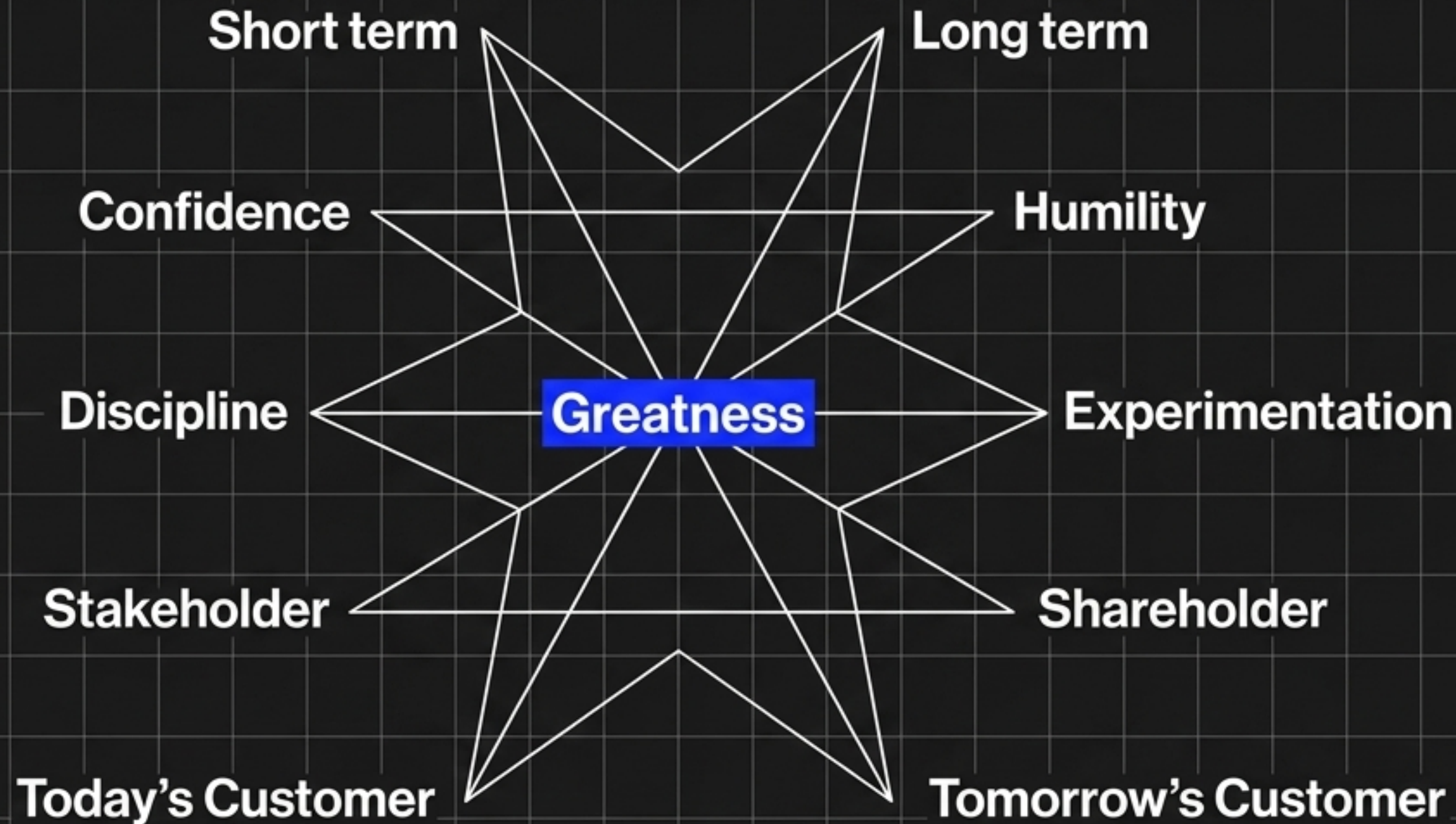
INNOVATION THE HORIZON

- 1. Innovation (3 Horizons)**
- 2. Disrupt or Defend**
- 3. AI Strategy**
- 4. Sustainability (ESG)**
- 5. The Future-Ready Leader
(Capstone)**

A future-ready leader is not the smartest in the room—they are the most adaptable.



THE FIVE LEADERSHIP TENSIONS



Greatness is holding both poles, not picking one.

THE INTEGRATION TEST

If you can answer these in one sentence each, you have integrated the course.

1. What is your strategy?
2. What is your North Star metric?
3. What is your moat?
4. What is your top constraint?
5. What is your next bet?

The plan is the artifact.
The leader is the system.